harvest the fruits of the revolution. Since Tahrir Square did not produce a real leader (Mohamed ElBaradei and Amr Moussa's appearances in the square were pathetic), the Egyptian army took over power, established a civilian government under its rule, and prepared the country for the first multiparty democratic elections since the Nasser revolution in 1952.

At the head of the council overseeing this transitional period was General Tantawi, an old fox but a sick and weak leader. The main dilemma facing the council's generals was their fate the day after free elections, with a new president and parliament who were elected by the people and whose source of authority would be the people and not the military, as had been the case until that point. The generals understood very well that they were the link between the old, hated regime and the future that was supposed to be democratic. Who could guarantee that the elected government, under the pressure of the masses, would not take the same approach as Friedrich von Schiller's character in the play *Fiesco*, that is, "The Moor has done his duty, the Moor can go," or even worse?

Meanwhile, the crowd in Tahrir Square dictated to the council and the government what to decide on its behalf. At the same time, the foundations of the previous regime were destroyed, the ruling party was disbanded, the Ministry of Internal Security almost ceased to function, prisons were demolished and tens of thousands of prisoners escaped, crime skyrocketed, public security deteriorated, and the economy crashed.

The most prominent political actor in Egypt is the Muslim Brotherhood. Their involvement in political life in Egypt has experienced many ups and downs, but no regime—not those of the kings or those of Nasser, Sadat, or Mubarak—has succeeded in expunging them. This is due to their dual identity—both that of a religious movement and that of a political organization. When their political activity is banned, it is still easy for them to survive and continue to exist as a religious movement. Their physical and organizational infrastructure easily serves both identities. Each mosque is also a party branch, and each imam is also the secretary of the branch. Every contribution to the mosque is also a contribution to political or social activity, and for any political activity a religious cover story can be crafted. It seemed that the Muslim Brotherhood was acting with great political wisdom when they informed the public—in order to reassure them—that they had no intention of putting forward a presidential candidate and that they intended to participate as a political party only in the parliamentary